

MINUTES

An **Evaluation Subcommittee Meeting** is held **May 22, 2023**, scheduled from 5pm - 6pm. The meeting is held via remote participation on Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45.

MEMORANDUM

As approved by the Committee on February 1, 2023 (2023-3): The Evaluation Subcommittee will meet to review and develop the process for the 2022-23 Superintendent Evaluation

AGENDA

As approved by the Evaluation Subcommittee on Thursday February 16, 2023, the Subcommittee will meet to create the composite evaluation.

Chair/Member Hays: opens the meeting and takes Roll Call: All subcommittee members present: 3/0
Chair/Member Sharon Hays, Member Jenny Graham, Member Melanie McLaughlin

Public Participation: Paul Gerety, Lisa Evangelista, Jess (?)

Chair Hays confirms she shared a folder of member evaluations with other subcommittee members. She began compiling the individual ratings into the composite - which she screen shares.

End of Cycle Summative Evaluation Report

The first page shows:

- Professional Practice Goals: one 'significant', five 'met', one 'exceeded'.
- Student Learning: one, 'some progress, one 'significant', one 'exceeded'.
- District Improvement Goals: three 'significant', three 'met', one 'exceeded'.

The combined scores consistently show, 'met'.

Member McLaughlin interjects, reiterating the scores and speaks to Step II where the numbers show to be 'proficient'. She comments that Member Hays is going to marry the comments

Member Hays confirms that is her plan.

Member McLaughlin continues and comments that the numbers will be discussed in the larger meeting.

Member Hays speaks to the three main areas ...

Member McLaughlin interjects and comments on qualitative data, the taking of the individual assessments and assigning them a number for 'significant progress', 'met' or 'exceeded' based on various committee members' input. The same with the standards that all agreed upon.

Member Hays confirms and acknowledges it was a good way to summarize.

Member McLaughlin comments/questions that there will be some qualitative data that will be brought to the table at the next school committee meeting?

Member Hays confirms that is the case and wonders if they can be worked on or if they can be compiled into a document (today?) or there is another subcommittee meeting scheduled where this can be looked at. Part of the process is the subcommittee would put in selected comments to represent the ratings and selected comments from various members evaluations and create the composite including the comments to bring to the whole committee.

Member McLaughlin asks if it would be helpful to have all of the narrative in one document such as a google doc, to be shared individually with subcommittee members, where they cannot respond to each other and so there is no violating any public meeting rules. Comments could be highlighted that are representative of the whole - prior to the next meeting.

Member Hays thinks that is the best way to move forward, as the time frame did not allow for that to happen prior (to this meeting). She will finish creating the google doc and can share it with Member McLaughlin and Member Graham prior to the June 1 meeting. She scrolls through the document to the superintendents specific goals (early literacy, her professional practice goal and her 3 district improvement goals, to share some of the other scores. The data was pulled straight out of everyone's individual evaluations and shows it all falls into the middle 'met' range. She continues to show the individual standards of the indicators of how people rated on the indicators.

Standard I: Instructional Leadership

Standard II: Management and Operations - there was just one indicator chosen

Standard III: Family and Community Engagement

Standard IV: Professional Culture

Member Hays inquires if a motion is necessary. She confirms she will create and send the document with the combined comments in order they can be gone through to fill in the comment sections on the composite, the next time the subcommittee meets.

Member Graham is fine with this approach

Member Hays is not sure there is a need to vote or if something more formal needs to be done?

Member Graham does not believe a motion is necessary and there are still two meetings (*scheduled*) to do this work. It's really a continuation and suggests that at the end of the meeting, instead of motioning to adjourn, there be a motion to continue the meeting.

Member McLaughlin comments - motion to table until the next meeting ... ? She comments for people watching, that the purpose of this meeting is not to discuss ... the Evaluation Subcommittee is to work on the process.

Member Graham confirms that instead of motioning to adjourn, there will be a motion to continue the meeting until June 1, 2023.

Member Hays asks if anyone has anything else to add. The data is in and (*all that is needed*) is to add in the comments.

Member McLaughlin asks for a timeline on when Member Hays would like to get the qualitative material

to the subcommittee members and when she would like them to get back to her with the highlighted material before the next meeting.

Member Hays confirms she will be updating the completed google doc that's already in the shared folder she provided to all. The next meeting will be for the committee to decide on the comments to go into the comments sections. There is nothing that needs to be sent to her.

Community Member Jess (unknown) asks if parents or teachers contribute their input for the performance grading or if it is just the school committee that does the grading for performance.

Member Hays responds that this is a school committee process. In terms of actual writing of the Superintendent Evaluation - that is the responsibility of the school committee. With regard to community input, that would be input (*submitted*) through evidence that the superintendent provides the subcommittee with input for any of the areas she's being evaluated for.

Member Graham: adds that it is a legal requirement - one of the 3 responsibilities set up under the law - and school committees do have some latitude in terms of what process they establish. She comments that Jess' comment is well taken and perhaps in the future, (*the subcommittee*) should think about public input to be part of the process as that's important to everyone as to how the process is laid out and how the report submitted to DESE is very defined in how the review was conducted.. In the future, it is to be considered to include community input for reporting. This would require additional steps in the process.

Community Member Paul Gerety asks that when this report is finally shared with the public as a whole, will the metrics used by the individuals (*committee members*) also be made part of the presentation. He references the columns with numbers and asks if (the public) will have some kind of metrics that shows what the individual reviewer is using to make the determination that resulted in a number for a particular category.

Member Hays responds that the subcommittee uses the self-evaluation from the superintendent, where she provides an update based on the agreed upon goals and indicators that the superintendent and the school committee discussed at the beginning of the year and she presented 2 weeks (prior to this meeting). This is the information that is used to complete the school committee evaluation.

Member Graham comments that the self evaluation also included various forms of evidence that support the narrative provided - for example the scores from the MAP testing from last year and this year to support evidence around the student learning goals. From the school committees point of view and experience as the evaluation is thought about along with the work of the school committee. All of that goes into everyone's individual ratings and rankings.

Community Member Paul Gerety asks if that was a uniform approach across the individual views. He continues to clarify to Member Hays' inquiry for elaboration on the question - that if 3 people are sitting in a class and 3 people make an observation, how is it determined that the same reference points, metrics and key indicators are being utilized.

Member Graham comments that the short answer is "you don't". There are seven individual members on the school committee - all who have different points of view and this is the way they coalesce to a single point of view that is the committee's view. All are looking at the same evidence; (*each person*) may see the evidence differently (*and have their own perspective*) due to deeper discussions being (*addressed*) outside of committee meetings. The first step is for the committee to say individually and independently how each is feeling. The ultimate product is that the review represents the committee's view by a majority vote.

Member McLaughlin comments that part of the process is that the subcommittee is going through in terms of making the process uniform, using the rubric that DESE provides around evaluation and identifying, in advance, what the goals (and items) are that are being evaluated. The committee is using this specific rubric to do so, which has not been the case in the past. All the material shared is publicly available information. DESE also has their superintendent rubric available online as was one of the reasons the committee wanted to standardize the form to use what other people are using across districts. What people report is also part of public information and is being shared as part of a vote taken earlier. The subcommittee is tasked with bringing all that information together. The qualitative information is more time consuming given the 7 individual narratives. A lot of these may be similar.

Member McLaughlin addresses the question asked by Jess (?). Part of the superintendent evaluation process (*is something that*) should be happening through the year. School committee members hear from constituents regarding their experiences in the district throughout the year; what they would like to see changed or improved, what they think is working and how things are happening. She thinks it is a longer conversation for the entire committee to have around public participation of the superintendent evaluation - as well as look at what other districts are doing and what their protocols are. This has to be a process that all agree, it is equitable and one that is consistent and one that MASC and the MASS would offer advice regarding best practices around (*the process*). She hopes (the community) continues to reach out to the committee and acknowledges the superintendent has been receptive to people reaching out to her as well. This is part of building relationships everyone should be working on for family and community engagement.

Paul Gerety speaks to his concern regarding the consistency of the review and the key indicators shared universally across all members when they make their determinations.

Member McLaughlin confirms that it is part of the data that and why the subcommittee is going with the same rubric shared with all the members across the board based on the items agreed to evaluate based on the superintendent's goals, making it much more uniform.

Member Hays comments that when this (*report*) is presented to the entire committee to vote on, it will be discussed (*at that meeting*) - and asks what the best way is to share it so everyone will have access to it. Several options have been discussed from putting both the composite and the individual evaluation on the website, as Members Graham and McLaughlin have confirmed it is all public information. DESE doesn't specify how it is shared; it is up to the school committee to make that decision. She has reviewed how other districts address and it is difficult to find the superintendent's evaluation. It is up to the school committee to create that process and decide how to share it for the community.

Paul Gerety comments that the explanation offered to educate the citizen in terms of what the key indicators were that were being observed and were universally applied across the board, was very helpful.

Member Graham comments that this is the only place where someone's performance review is aired in public. She thinks it is awkward and a problematic process for many reasons, which is probably why you don't see too many districts blasting this information on their websites. At the end of the day, Dr Edouard-Vincent is the employee of the school committee. There is the need to be mindful of employment laws and take care to balance the fact that this is all public information and the fact that the superintendent is (our) employee and she does have rights as an employee of the district.

Paul Gerety agrees but thinks it necessary to take it to a higher level. These are the goals. These are the metrics to see if the goals were achieved and how the people on the reviewing committee apply those metrics to the goals that were stated are fair enough.

Member Graham comments that the measures were selected in open meeting and suggests that perhaps there could be a summary slide that can be put together to say this was the focus for this year.

Paul Gerety thinks the program overall is what's important to make a judgment on and everybody contributes their part to ...

Member Hays also thinks it's important to note that the Superintendent's goals for the year, along with shared goals of the superintendent and school committee - are worked on together, from the beginning of the year ... and the decisions about what the particular focus areas are done in open meeting and publicly available and posted on the website.

Paul Gerety had the original draft to review it quite often.

Member McLaughlin it is a good idea to provide a one page primer information slide to orient the community and communicate the evaluation process - here are the goals, here are the (*elements chosen*) for evaluating, here's the evaluation and provides a record of the information as to what the process was. She offers to assist Member Hays (*with this proposal*).

Member Hays appreciates the offer that someone else (Member McLaughlin) picks up on the creation of the proposed slide.

Motion to continue the meeting to June 1, 2023 made by Member Mclaughlin; seconded by Member Hays.

Motion carries 3/0

Meeting Suspended: 5:39p